QUICK GUIDE

WHITE & PINK NOISE

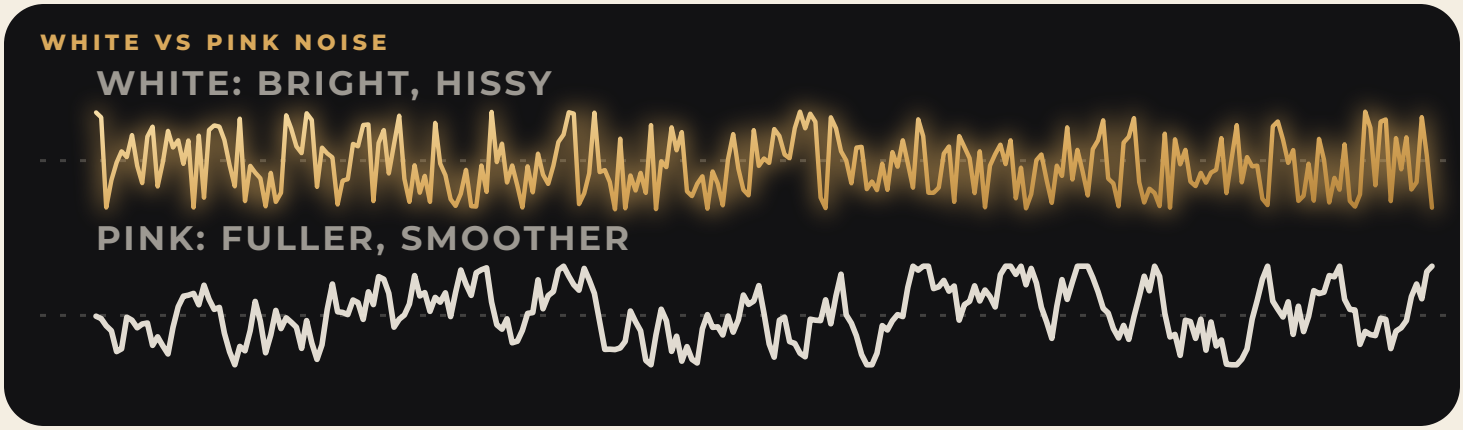
What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

WHAT IT IS

White noise has the same energy at every frequency. Pink noise has the same energy in every octave, so it has more low end and less high end than white noise.

HOW IT SOUNDS

White: bright and hissy, like static. Pink: softer and more natural, like steady rain.



01

WHITE NOISE IS BRIGHT

A flat spectrum. Used for risers, sweeps and impacts.

02

PINK NOISE IS BALANCED

Rolls off 3 dB per octave. Warmer, closer to how we hear.

03

DIFFERENT JOBS

White for transitions. Pink for testing a room or speakers.

DO THIS TONIGHT

White builds tension. Pink checks the room. Keep both quiet.

- [ ] Layer white noise under a riser to build into a drop.
- [ ] Play pink noise low to hear your room and speakers.
- [ ] Keep both quiet. Noise should support the music.



PRACTICE & CHECK

WHITE & PINK NOISE: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- White noise sweeps and risers build tension into a drop.
- Pink noise is used to check speaker and room balance.
- Noise layered with a snare adds crack and air.

QUICK CHECK

1. Which noise is brighter?

2. What makes pink noise pink?

3. Which one do you use to check a room?

Answer key: 1) White noise. 2) Equal energy per octave, so it rolls off toward the highs. 3) Pink noise, at a low volume.

REMEMBER

White builds tension. Pink checks the room.

YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Complex Waveform

